CoderPad — Candidate Guide

Welcome to your technical interview. This guide covers everything you need to know before you start.

Before Your Interview

You don't need to install anything. CoderPad runs entirely in your browser.

What you need:

- A modern desktop browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari 16+)
- A stable internet connection
- The interview link sent to you by your recruiter or interviewer

Recommended: Test your setup 5 minutes before the interview starts by opening the link and confirming the editor loads.

Joining the Interview

Open the link you received. It looks like:

```
https://sigma-computing-interview-app.vercel.app/#iid=...&role=candidate
```

The editor opens immediately — no sign-in required. You are automatically connected to your interviewer's session.

> ***Do not share your link*** *— it gives direct access to your interview session.*

The Editor

> ***Screenshot:*** *The candidate editor showing a code area, language selector (top-left), font size controls, Run button (top-right), and problem description panel above the editor.*

Everything you type is visible to your interviewer in real time. Think of it like pair programming — your interviewer is watching a live view of your screen.

Choosing a Language

Click the **language dropdown** in the toolbar to select your preferred language.

Available languages: JavaScript · TypeScript · Python · Java · C++ · C · Go · Ruby · Rust · Bash · PHP

> ***Warning:*** *Switching languages clears your current code. Choose your language before you start writing.*

The Problem Description

If your interviewer has sent a problem, it appears as a **read-only panel** above your editor.

> ***Screenshot:*** *A problem description panel showing a coding question with examples, above the code editor. The panel has a scroll bar for long problems.*

- You can scroll the description panel if it is long

- You cannot edit the problem statement
- The panel may not appear immediately — your interviewer can send a question at any point

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Writing Your Solution

Type your solution in the editor. The editor supports:

- Syntax highlighting for your chosen language
- Auto-indent and bracket matching
- Standard keyboard shortcuts (Ctrl+Z to undo, Ctrl+F to find, etc.)
- Code folding (click the arrow next to a line number)

There is no "submit" button. Your interviewer watches your progress live. Just write your best solution.

Running Your Code

Click ▶ **Run** in the top toolbar to execute your code.

> ***Screenshot:*** *The toolbar with the Run button highlighted. Below the editor, the Output panel is expanded showing "Hello, world!" in the stdout section.*

Providing test input (stdin): Click the **Stdin** panel to expand it. Type or paste your test input before clicking Run.

Reading output:

Section	Content
(white text)	Standard output — what your code printed
STDERR (red label)	Error messages and stack traces
Exit code badge	✓ = success (exit 0) · Exit N = error
Execution time	Shown in milliseconds (ms)

Limits:

- 10 seconds maximum runtime — code that runs longer is killed automatically
- 256 MB memory limit
- If you see `[Output truncated]`, your program printed more than 256 KB

Tips for a Smooth Interview

1. **Talk through your approach** — your interviewer hears you; the editor alone doesn't convey your thinking.
2. **Don't refresh the page** — your code is not saved server-side. A refresh will lose your work.
3. **Use the Stdin panel** for test cases rather than hardcoding inputs into your code.
4. **Test incrementally** — run your code early and often, even with a partial solution.
5. **If the editor freezes**, a page reload will reconnect you. Your session stays active.

When the Session Ends

Your interviewer will end the session when the interview is complete. You will see:

> ***Screenshot:*** *The "Interview Complete" full-screen overlay with a green checkmark, "Interview Complete" heading, a message "The interviewer has ended this session. Thank you for your time.", and a countdown "This window will close in 7 seconds..." with a "Close now" button.*

- A full-screen overlay appears with "Interview Complete"
- A countdown from 10 seconds begins
- The window closes automatically when it reaches zero
- You can click **Close now** to dismiss immediately

Troubleshooting

The editor won't load / page is blank

- Hard-refresh: `Ctrl+Shift+R` (Windows/Linux) or `Cmd+Shift+R` (Mac)
- Try a different browser (Chrome is recommended)
- Check your internet connection

My code ran but I see no output

- Your program may have exited without printing anything. Check for a `return` before your `print` / `System.out.println` / `console.log`.
- Check the STDERR section for error messages.

"Execution timed out"

- Your code ran for more than 10 seconds. Look for infinite loops or recursion that doesn't terminate.

"Server busy — too many concurrent executions"

- The server is under load. Wait 15 seconds and try again.

The page shows an error or goes blank mid-interview

- Reload the page — your session link is still valid. Your connection will be restored automatically.

Privacy

- Your code is transmitted to the interview server for execution when you click **Run**
- Your keystrokes are shared with your interviewer in real time throughout the session
- The interviewer's browser records snapshots of your code automatically as a session recording
- No audio or video is captured by CoderPad